



PROPOSAL · PUBLIC ART COMMISSION

Springfield Village Southern Gateway

Rona Smith

A physical model of the proposed gateway is at the AND office. The model can be handled — the gate opens by hand, and the proposal can be viewed from different angles.

R O N A

01 / 08

From an orchard, an apple. From an apple, a gate.

A design rooted in the lesser-known history of the Springfield site, made meaningful and locally relevant.

The site

Between 1841 and 1948 the Springfield hospital ran the only working farm in London. The Wandsworth archives hold cuttings, books and photographs that describe a hospital where patients were encouraged to engage in farmwork as part of a rehabilitation scheme. Within that farm — an orchard.

The apple, and its segments

I use the form of an apple and its segments as the starting point. A series of stacked apples with a geometric lattice across each — inspired by my drawings of cut apple segments and their seed casings.

The apple symbolises health and wellbeing — reflecting the development's ambition to break down barriers around mental health. The acronym *APPLE* (Acknowledge, Pause, Pull back, Let go, Explore) is a mindfulness technique now widely used to navigate intrusive thoughts. In the context of Streatham Cemetery, the theme also evokes new life growing from a place of remembrance — the seeds of new beginnings.



A welcoming landmark, not a railing.

The gate replaces a typical vertical railing with a soothing, rhythmic geometry — apple segments stacked in a calming pattern.

The smooth, rounded shapes are harmonious with the foliage of the cemetery and park, while the repeating stacked fruit echoes the brick formation of the old retaining wall adjacent to the work.

Within each segment, an intricate internal lattice evokes a broader vocabulary of natural shapes — the veins of a butterfly wing, the structured shell of a beetle. The geometry encourages a fluid association of ideas rather than presenting a literal illustration.





R O N A

The Southern Gateway, to scale.

An interactive 3D model is available on the web version of this proposal.

OVERALL DIMENSIONS

Overall width	3,458 mm
Main panel	2,000 × 2,000 mm
Arch height	855 mm
Side panel	235 mm
Hedgehog opening	130 mm

STEEL SPECIFICATION

Plate	8 mm laser-cut steel
Artwork frame	50 × 50 × 5 SHS
Gate pier	100 × 50 × 6 RHS
Gate border	50 × 50 × 6 RSA
Max aperture	100 mm

SHS — square hollow section. RHS — rectangular hollow section. RSA — rolled steel angles (L-shaped).

Scalability

The railing matches the original brick retaining wall. The arch and height can be scaled up without compromising the design — by adding rows to the stacked apple pattern and extending the arch outward.

Built to last, finished to integrate.

8 mm laser-cut steel, zinc-sprayed and architecturally powder-coated for 25+ years' durability in a C₃ environment.

Coating specification

Degrease to SSPC-SP-1 → Grit Blast to BS 7079 SA 2.5 → Zinc Metal Spray to BS EN ISO 2063 → Bondakote Primer → Polyester architectural powder coat.

Permeability & safety

100 mm maximum aperture maintained throughout the design — compliant with anti-trap standards. Solid sections at the edges ensure robustness and stability.

Locking, ecology & wayfinding

Handle, lock and key included; fob access available on request. A 130 mm ground opening preserves the boundary as a wildlife corridor. "Springfield Park" is engraved and infilled into the arch above the gate on both sides. LED uplighters enhance the shadow play shown in the physical model.



Delivery, by a trusted team.

My project management approach is based on good communication and collaboration — rigorous quality control while achieving the artistic vision. I share weekly updates with the project team, hold regular workshop inspections during fabrication, and provide photographic documentation of milestones before any drawdowns of incurred costs.

Team

Benson Sedgwick Engineering · Dagenham

Fabrication. A regular collaborator on my previous gates.

Bradleys Metal Finishers · Ipswich

Powder coating. Painted and powder-coated several of my previous commissions.

Fold Engineering · Bath

Structural engineering. Has carried out calculations for many previous projects.

PROJECT PROGRAMME

MILESTONE	DATE
Design development & stakeholder consultation	8 Jun – 13 Jul
Draft design submitted	13 Jul
Artworks signed off	10 Aug
Order materials & fabrication	Aug – Dec
Community workshops with students	Sep / Oct
Finish applied	Jan 2027
Delivery & installation	Jan 2027
Sign off	Jan 2027

Two phases of engagement.

Heritage preservation through consultation, and professional development for young creatives within the borough.

Design phase — Friends of Streatham Cemetery

Guided walks and listening sessions along the boundary wall. The Friends carry the stories, history and heritage of the place; their input will shape the symbolism and detailing. The aim: leave the group knowing the gateway honours the character of the place they have stewarded.

Fabrication phase — local Art & Design students

Each student designs their own gate — starting with a pen drawing, ending with a physical miniature laser-cut in brass. They learn to design with structural integrity in mind, then integrate their brass panel into a larger model framework using styrene, carbon-fibre dowling, acrylic and flock.

Proposed educational partners

Bishop Thomas Grant Sixth Form, Streatham · La Retraite Sixth Form, Clapham Park · Lambeth College, Clapham Common — prioritised by proximity and the relevance of their Art and Design provision.



Budget.

ARTIST FEE

Research, project management, design development, engagement, liaison	£18,000
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INCURRED COSTS

Materials, fabrication, engraving, plaque, delivery & installation	£36,335
CAD drawings and calculations	£2,000
Engagement materials	£800
Contingency (10%)	£3,915
Total incurred costs	£43,050
Total	£61,050 + VAT

Key risks.

- Risk — **Material / fabrication delays (steel lead times)**

Mitigation — Pre-order materials at contract signing; 3-week buffer in the Aug-Dec fabrication window.
- Risk — **Site interface mismatch (brick wall / railings vary from drawings)**

Mitigation — Physical site survey and laser-measure before finalising drawings; connection posts detailed with 50 mm tolerance.
- Risk — **Structural integrity & wind loading**

Mitigation — Formal calculations with Fold Engineering. Gate frames engineered for high wind loads and heavy daily use before sign-off.
- Risk — **Coating failure (corrosion adjacent to park foliage)**

Mitigation — High-grade shot-blasting, hot zinc spray and architectural powder coat via Bradleys — prevents rust bleeding onto historic brick piers.
- Risk — **Public safety & aperture trapping**

Mitigation — All segment voids verified at digital drafting; 100 mm maximum aperture sphere clearance maintained throughout.